

Business Communication: Principles & Purpose

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1. Introduction to Communication

A. What is Communication?

At its core, **communication** is a fundamental human activity that happens continuously in our daily lives, whether with friends, family, or colleagues .

- **Definition:** Communication is the **exchange of information, ideas, thoughts, or opinions** . This exchange can occur through speaking, writing, or any other medium .
- **Core Concept:** It involves **transferring information** from one place, person, or group to another .

B. Etymology (Latin Origins)

The word "Communication" is derived from two Latin terms, which are commonly asked in business examinations]:

1. **Communis (Noun):** Means "**Common**" . It signifies sharing what we know so that it becomes a shared or common understanding between parties .
2. **Communicare (Verb):** Means "**Sharing, informing, spreading, or making common**" .

C. Classic Definitions by Management Experts

Different scholars have defined communication to highlight its operational and psychological aspects:

Scholar	Definition of Communication	Key Focus
Newman and Summer	<i>"An exchange of facts, ideas, opinions, or emotions by two or more persons."</i>	Focuses on the exchange of emotional and intellectual inputs between people.
Little	<i>"A process by which information is transmitted between individuals and organizations for understanding and response."</i>	Focuses on the transmission of information to elicit a specific response or action.

2. Business Communication

A. Meaning & Definition

Business Communication is not just normal conversation; it is communication specifically tied to business activities .

- **Definition:** It is the process of sharing information between people **within and outside** a company .
- **Main Motive:** Its core objective is to facilitate employee and management interaction to **achieve organizational goals** .

B. Internal vs. External Communication

Business communication flows in two main directions :

- **Internal Communication (Within the Company):**
 - Occurs between employees and management (Top-level, Middle-level, and Lower-level) .

- Examples include passing orders and instructions, training staff, and conveying rules/guidelines .
- Employees also use it to communicate grievances, feedback, and operational updates to the upper management .
- **External Communication (Outside the Company):**
 - Involves communicating with external stakeholders like suppliers, transportation partners, government bodies, and handling documentation/licensing .

3. Nature & Characteristics of Business Communication

Understanding how business communication functions is vital. Here are its key characteristics:

1. **Continuous Process:** It is not a one-time event . It is an ongoing, daily activity where facts, ideas, and opinions are constantly shared .
2. **Two-Way Process:** Communication cannot exist in a vacuum or be one-sided . It requires a **Sender** to transmit the message, a **Receiver** to understand it, and **Feedback/Response** to complete the cycle . Just speaking without a response is not true communication .
3. **Inevitable & Unavoidable:** It is impossible to avoid communication in an organization . Every action, directive, or collaboration relies on it .
4. **Pervasive (Omnipresent):** It is required at every level of management (Top, Middle, and Lower) and across all departments .
5. **Facilitates Change:** If a business wants to change its working patterns, time schedules, rules, or introduce new

machinery, it can only do so by communicating effectively with its employees .

6. **Removes Misunderstandings & Conflicts:** Effective communication resolves confusion and reduces friction within teams, boosting employee productivity and morale.

4. Purpose & Objectives of Business Communication

Why is effective communication essential in a business? Its key purposes include :

- **To Issue Orders and Instructions:** Enables managers to assign roles, delegate duties, and issue clear directives (written or oral) .
- **To Coordinate Across Levels:** Helps in communicating smoothly with superiors, peers, and subordinates .
- **To Convey the Right Information:** Ensures that accurate details reach the right person at the right time .
- **To Solicit Suggestions & Feedback:** Encourages team members and subordinates to share their ideas and suggestions before making decisions .
- **To Persuade and Counsel People:** Used by managers to guide demotivated employees, counsel those facing challenges, resolve conflicts, and keep morale high .
- **Training and Development:** Critical for conducting training sessions to develop employee skills and career paths .
- **To Achieve Organizational Goals:** The ultimate purpose of all business communication is to align human effort so that the company's objective is reached successfully .